

SAMYUKTA KURIKALA

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SUMMARY

Detection-focused security analyst with hands-on investigation experience in Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Splunk (SPL), and Wazuh, backed by regular placement in blue-team CTFs across forensics, log analysis, and network traffic analysis. M.S. in Cybersecurity, Security+ certified, building automation tooling for detection engineering.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SIEM & Detection: Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Splunk (SPL), Wazuh, Security Onion, Defender XDR, Sigma rules

Host & Log Analysis: Sysmon, Windows event logs (EVTX), Hayabusa, process and command-line telemetry, IOC enrichment

Automation & Scripting: Python, PowerShell, Bash, MCP (Model Context Protocol), Docker Compose

Cloud & Platforms: Azure, AWS, Windows, Linux (Ubuntu/Debian)

Frameworks & IR: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61, NIST CSF, incident response, playbook development

Certifications: CompTIA Security+, CompTIA SecAI+ Google Professional Cybersecurity, ISC2 CC

WORK EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst Training

Remote

IBM Virtual Cyber Range (Northeastern Cohort)

July 2026 – September 2026

- Investigated 10+ simulated incidents to confirm root cause by writing SPL queries in Splunk and analyzing endpoint, network, and DNS telemetry in Security Onion, correlated with Palo Alto NGFW and pfSense firewall logs across Windows and Linux endpoints
- Worked incidents that covered phishing, cryptomining, ransomware and data breach scenarios, establishing attack timelines, mapping confirmed activity to MITRE ATT&CK, and documenting investigations as published writeups

Security and Compliance Intern

Remote

Artelus.ai

January 2026 – May 2026

- Assessed organizational risk posture against HIPAA, FDA, and CE frameworks by mapping each finding to its applicable control, the same gap-to-framework analysis used in NIST CSF and MITRE ATT&CK assessments
- Prioritized findings by exploitability and business impact, delivering a severity-classified assessment report with proof-of-concept documentation to drive remediation sequencing

Graduate Teaching Assistant – Cybersecurity Principles and Practices

Remote

Khoury College of Computer Sciences

January 2026 – May 2026

- Taught incident response fundamentals through playbook development for phishing, credential harvesting, and endpoint compromise, covering CSIRT roles and containment steps
- Instructed 15+ graduate students on Linux hardening, IAM, network proxy configuration, Bash scripting, and cryptographic systems, mentoring and grading technical work

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Agentic Detection Engineering Workbench | Python, MCP, Hayabusa, Sigma

- Built a Python MCP server wrapping the Hayabusa EVTX scanner, exposing 4 tools with JSON Schema parameters for severity filtering, rule matching, and result limiting, returning parsed structured detections instead of raw event XML
- Exposed a Sigma rule and MITRE ATT&CK knowledge base as MCP resources with a URI-addressable scheme, enabling technique-level lookup of which rules detect a given ATT&CK ID
- Implemented coverage analysis cross-referencing the Sigma ruleset against ATT&CK techniques to surface detection gaps

Wazuh SIEM Home Lab | Wazuh, Docker Compose, Sysmon

- Deployed Wazuh SIEM/XDR via Docker Compose with agents on a Windows workstation and Linux SSH bastion, centralizing Sysmon process, command line, and network telemetry
- Documented per-host baselines, then authored 11 custom rules spanning valid account abuse (T1078.003), PowerShell and shell execution (T1059.001/003), account creation (T1136.001), and SSH lateral movement (T1021.004), validating each through simulated attacks and tuning exclusions to suppress legitimate activity

Microsoft Sentinel Detection & Investigation Lab | Microsoft Defender, KQL, Azure, Log Analytics

- Investigating incidents from alert to root cause, building entity timelines with KQL joins across identity, endpoint, and network log sources, published as written investigation narratives
- Deployed the Sentinel Training Lab into a Log Analytics workspace onboarded to Defender XDR, working telemetry from CrowdStrike, Palo Alto, Okta, AWS CloudTrail, GCP, and email security

EDUCATION

Northeastern University

Boston, MA

M.S. in Cybersecurity [3.72/4.00]

September 2024 – May 2026

RECOGNITION & INVOLVEMENT

WiCyS Scholarship Recipient – Competitively selected for the 2026 WiCyS Annual Conference

Top 50 Globally – WiCyS Target Cyber Defense CTF Challenge | **3rd Place** – Viceroy Decree CTF

Community: WiCyS Global and AI Affiliate member; Layer 8, Boston Security Meetup, Boston Hackers, DEF CON 617